

Tech TODAY Daily Drivers

The refreshed lines from Samsung and Apple offer a lot to those looking for a device for daily computing. Take your pick **BY NIDHI SINGAL**

PHOTOS BY **MANISH RAJPUT**

REVIEW

MINI-MUM FUSS

The compact square Mac mini handles basic tasks and more with aplomb

► **LAPTOPS** are convenient to tote around, but a huge audience swears by desktops. While Apple offers a wide range of all-in-one desktops—iMacs, with a starting price of ₹1,24,990—it's the Mac mini that brings the power of the Mac operating system and Apple's processor-making chops at a relatively lower cost, and in a compact plug-and-play format. In the box you find the square-shaped Mac Mini and just the power cable. You'll need to connect this to your choice of keyboard, mouse and display—you can even connect this to your TV! Do note that if you're setting it up for the first time with non-Apple accessories, you need to use a wired keyboard and mouse. Besides the keyboard, display and mouse, you might want to invest in quality speakers (the built-in speaker is average at best) and a webcam (if you're into video calling). And you're set.

This Mac Mini has a small footprint and can be tucked away easily. You can even carry it around if you want. All its ports are at the rear: the power button and port, two Thunderbolt 4 USB-C ports, two USB-A ports, an HDMI port, a 10-gigabit ethernet port and a 3.5-mm headphone jack along with vents for cooling. A caveat: having all the ports at the rear can be cumbersome if you switch between external hard drives often.

If you're logging into Mac OS for the first time, just follow the instructions and you'll be good to go in minutes. But if you are switching from an existing Mac, it might take a bit longer to transfer your data. At the heart of the Mac mini is Apple's M2 chip with an 8-core CPU and 10-core GPU, and with a 16-core Neural Engine; the M2 is in no way inferior to Intel's processors in terms of performance. It's great for daily usage as it handles with aplomb tasks such as documentation and presentations, browsing the web, video calls, basic image and video editing, gaming and coding. But if you're looking to render and edit videos over extended periods, consider

picking its powerful sibling, which has the more powerful M2 Pro processor and additional ports. Also, if you're not saving your files to external drives or a network drive, consider investing in as much internal storage as you can.

If you are shifting to a Mac from Windows, you'll need to invest in compatible software. That said, Apple has a very capable free office suite, while its free video editing software called iMovies is good for basic video editing. Overall, the Mac Mini is an affordable system for home or office use that does not compromise on efficiency, power or space.

Available on: apple.com/in

SPECS 7.75x7.75x1.41 inch; 1.18kg; macOS Ventura; Apple M2 Chip; 8GB unified memory; 256GB storage; support for two displays; 3.5mm port; two Type-C Thunderbolt 4 ports; one HDMI port; two Type-A USB ports; Ethernet; Wi-Fi 6E, Bluetooth 5.3

